

Gospel



A crier lifts a horn in a crowded street. People lean in, faces open. He is not leading a seminar. He is announcing something that has happened.

Before you gather

- Read Day 11, Gospel, in The Visual Gospel. Do not reteach the essay.
- Read 1 Corinthians 15:1–5 in your Bible. The excerpt below is only a backup.
- Your people should already have answered the day's reflection questions. Do not ask those again.

- Leave with a name. The missional challenge only works if someone is named before you pray.

1 · ICEBREAKER · 7 MIN

Open the room

What is news you told somebody the same day you heard it?

Leader. News is announced. It is not a tip for a better life. Then open 1 Corinthians 15 and read the facts. Say that passing is allowed, especially the first few weeks.

2 · THE WORD · 8 MIN

See it, then say it

IF YOU NEED THE WORDS

Say: The gospel is news, not advice. Christ died for our sins, was buried, and rose. God commands us to repent and believe.

DEFINITION, FROM THE BOOK

The gospel is the good news of what God has done in Jesus Christ to save sinners through His life, death, resurrection, and exaltation, calling all people to repent and believe for forgiveness of sins and eternal life.

IN THE ORIGINAL LANGUAGE

Greek euangelion — good news, a message announced, not advice offered.

MEMORY VERSE · LUKE 2:10–11

And the angel said to them, “Fear not, for behold, I bring you good news of great joy that will be for all the people. For unto you is born this day in the city of David a Savior, who is Christ the Lord.”

Together, open the flashcard for Gospel. Say the word, the definition, and the verse once. Then put the phone away.

3 · OPEN THE BIBLE · 15 MIN

1 Corinthians 15:1–5

Luke 2 is the memory verse. Stay in 1 Corinthians 15:1–5. Paul tells a church what the gospel is, of first importance. Ask what the text says before anyone tells their story.

Now I would remind you, brothers, of the gospel I preached to you, which you received, in which you stand, and by which you are being saved, if you hold fast to the word I preached to you — unless you believed in vain. For I delivered to you as of first importance what I also received: that Christ died for our sins in accordance with the Scriptures, that he was buried, that he was raised on the third day in accordance with the Scriptures, and that he appeared to Cephas, then to the twelve.

Have two readers if you can. Bibles open. The excerpt is only here so a forgotten Bible does not stop the night.

From the passage

1. Paul lists events. What are they, and what kinds of things are not on his list? **CORE**

Leader. Christ died for our sins, was buried, was raised the third day, and appeared. Missing: advice, self-help, and a mood. The center is what Jesus did in history, according to the Scriptures.

2. He says they are saved by this gospel if they hold fast. What does that do to a gospel that is only a feeling?

Leader. A feeling is not the gospel. Holding fast means you keep trusting the news of Christ's death and resurrection. Do not send them inward to hunt for a spark.

4 · AROUND THE ROOM · 20 MIN

A conversation this chapter did not assign

3. Romans 1:16 says the gospel is the power of God for salvation to everyone who believes. Who saves, and what must a person do?

Leader. God saves. The person believes. We do not add our record to Christ's work.

4. Acts 17:30 says God commands all people everywhere to repent. If the gospel is news, why is there a command? **CORE**

Leader. News demands a response. Repent and believe. Do not leave the room thinking we may ignore it.

5. If you had one minute with a neighbor, which lines from 1 Corinthians 15:3–4 would you actually say?

Leader. Make them say it: Christ died for our sins, was buried, and was raised. Clumsy and true is the goal.

5 • SAY IT • 5 MIN

In one sentence

The gospel is the news that Christ died for our sins, was buried, and rose again, and that we must repent and believe.

Ask for two volunteers, not the whole circle. They may look at the sentence, then try it without looking. Clumsy and true is the goal.

6 • THIS WEEK • 5 MIN

Missional challenge

Before next week, carry this word to someone far from Jesus — a neighbor, a classmate, a coworker, a friend. Do it with a real action and with a true sentence. Name the person before you pray.

Tell one person that Christ died for our sins, was buried, and rose. Then do one ordinary kindness so they know you mean it.

Leader. Lead with His news, not your story. Practice the sentence in the room before anyone leaves. A kindness that never names Christ is not the whole challenge. Next week, before the icebreaker, take one minute. Who went, and what happened? One sentence. No speeches.

7 • PRAY • 8 MIN

Pray these, and leave room for others

1. Father, thank You for news that is true whether we feel it or not.
2. Forgive us for turning the gospel into tips and leaving out the cross.
3. Send us to one person this week with 1 Corinthians 15:3–4 on our lips.

Before you stumble

Do not shrink this to “God loves you and has a plan” with no sin, no cross, and no resurrection. Do not say the whole world is already saved. The text says Christ died for our sins, and it calls people to hold fast. Correct a false gospel kindly, and do it.

WITH STUDENTS

Have them say “died for our sins, buried, raised” out loud once before they leave. That is the gospel. Then ask who they will tell.

IF YOU STILL HAVE TIME

Mark 1:15. The kingdom is at hand. Repent and believe the gospel. Read it and stop.